

3.5 Unit 5 PHA5A-5D Nuclear Physics, Thermal Physics and an Optional Topic

This unit consists of two sections. The first part of Section A 'Nuclear and Thermal Physics' looks at the characteristics of the nucleus, the properties of unstable nuclei and how energy is obtained from the nucleus. In the second part of Section A, the thermal properties of materials and the properties and nature of gases are studied in depth.

Section B offers an opportunity to study one of the following optional topics to gain deeper understanding and awareness of a selected branch of physics:

- A Astronomy and cosmology
- B Medical Physics
- C Applied Physics
- D Turning Points in Physics.

Nuclear and Thermal Physics